

Account-Based Marketing (ABM) Offering Toolkit

UPDATED: NOVEMBER 2025

B2B Transformation

WHAT IT IS

B2B sales transformation involves new processes, technology, data, and insights to allow sales teams to engage business customers more efficiently and effectively. Key capabilities are Sales, Service, Commerce, and Analytics and Reporting.

B2B sales transformation engagements are typically preceded by B2B Transformation - Wedge Offerings that identify a North Star vision for the client to rally around.

Key Stakeholders: CRO/VP Sales, CDO/CTO/VP Commerce, CIO

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- Reduced cost to serve
- Increased customer acquisition
- Increased AOV
- Increased customer retention rates

See next pages for wedge and packaged engagement details for each module.

GTM HUB PAGE

This [link](#) has all the content to support the offering: training, engagement models, case studies, thought leadership, Merkle reports, etc.

SUB-OFFERING

Account-Based Selling

AI-led Service and Advisory

Account-based Marketing
(ABM)

Account-based Operations
and Automation

YOUR 2-PAGE SUMMARY

Account-Based Marketing (ABM)

WHAT IT IS

Our ABM offerings create strategic alignment across marketing, sales, and leadership on account priorities and resource allocation—enabled by data and technology infrastructure that supports account-level orchestration and buying group identification.

Through account intelligence and segmentation, we prioritize high-value accounts and orchestrate personalized journeys across paid, owned, and earned channels. Measurement frameworks connect tactics to business outcomes, while dedicated program management ensures operational excellence through continuous optimization.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- **Higher Revenue Per Account** - Larger deal sizes and faster cycles from targeting high-value accounts
- **Improved Marketing ROI** - Clear measurement linking investments directly to pipeline and revenue
- **Accelerated Sales Velocity** - Reduced friction enables concentration on warm, high-intent prospects
- **Increased Customer Lifetime Value** - Structured approach to identify and capture growth (upsell/cross-sell) within existing clients

WEDGE

Can be delivered at **less than \$250k** USD, to 'open the door'.

ABM Audit and Strategic Visioning

\$100-300K USD

Data and Tech Architecture and Roadmap

\$150-350K USD

ENGAGEMENTS

Are **over \$250k** USD that you can sell individually or together.

ABM Pilot Program

\$200-425K USD

ABM Blueprint

\$300-600K USD

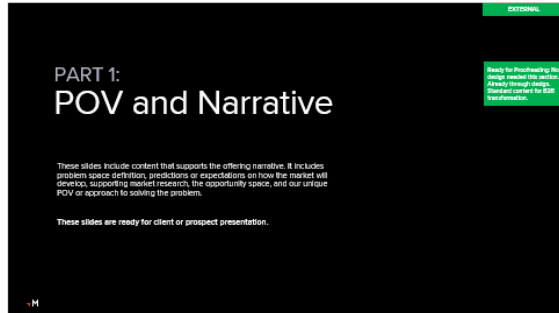
ABM Activation and Program Management

\$500K-1M USD

WHAT'S INSIDE

PART 1: POV and Narrative

EXTERNAL



[LINK](#)

PART 2: Case Studies and Why Merkle

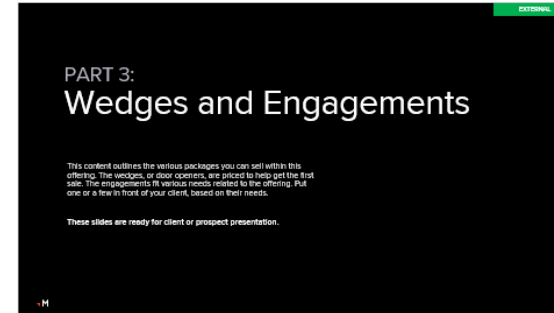
EXTERNAL



[LINK](#)

PART 3: Wedges and Engagements

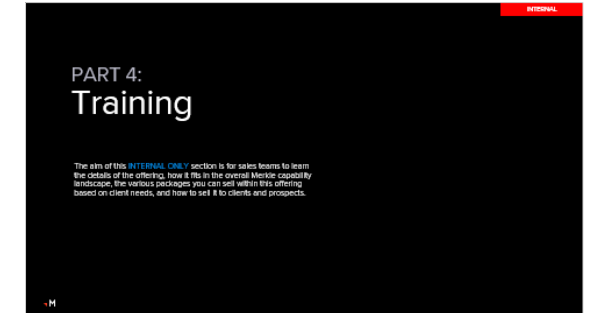
EXTERNAL



[LINK](#)

PART 4: Training

INTERNAL



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)

PART 1: POV and Narrative

Ready for Proofreading: No design needed this section. Already through design. Standard content for B2B transformation.

These slides include content that supports the offering narrative. It includes problem space definition, predictions or expectations on how the market will develop, supporting market research, the opportunity space, and our unique POV or approach to solving the problem.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

The most successful businesses have
always known **how to ride waves.**

A dramatic photograph of a massive ocean wave crashing, with white foam and deep blue water. The sky is dark and stormy, adding to the sense of power and danger. The wave is the central focus, with its crest breaking into a large, white plume of foam.

**But now, the waves are crashing
down on B2B customers.**

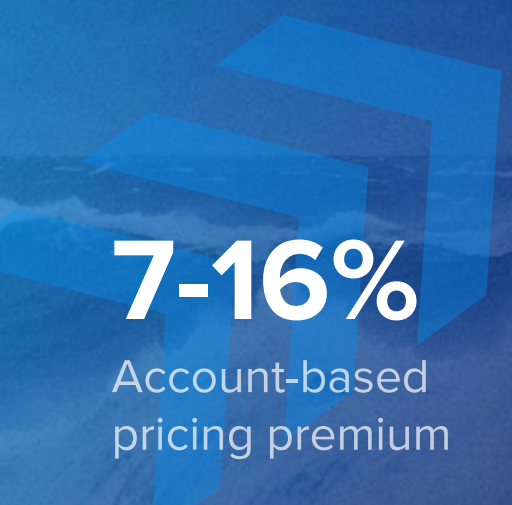


**Profitability
Pressure**

**AI
Uncertainty**

**Workforce
Fatigue**

**Geopolitical
Instability**



7-16%

Account-based
pricing premium

1.7x

Increase in B2B
account retention

54%

lower rate of burnout
among employees

52%

anticipate tariffs will
amplify economic
contraction

The stakes have never been higher.

B2B has never been
more competitive

+62%

increase in brands considered for the
average B2B purchase

Deal cycles have never
been **more complex**

+4.5

Increase in weeks of the average B2B
purchase lifecycle since 2022, to 379 days

And the job
has never
been harder.

B2B buyers don't feel
heard or well understood

71%

of B2B buyers say they want suppliers to
spend more time understanding and solving
their **day-to-day problems**

Buyers are more
frustrated than ever

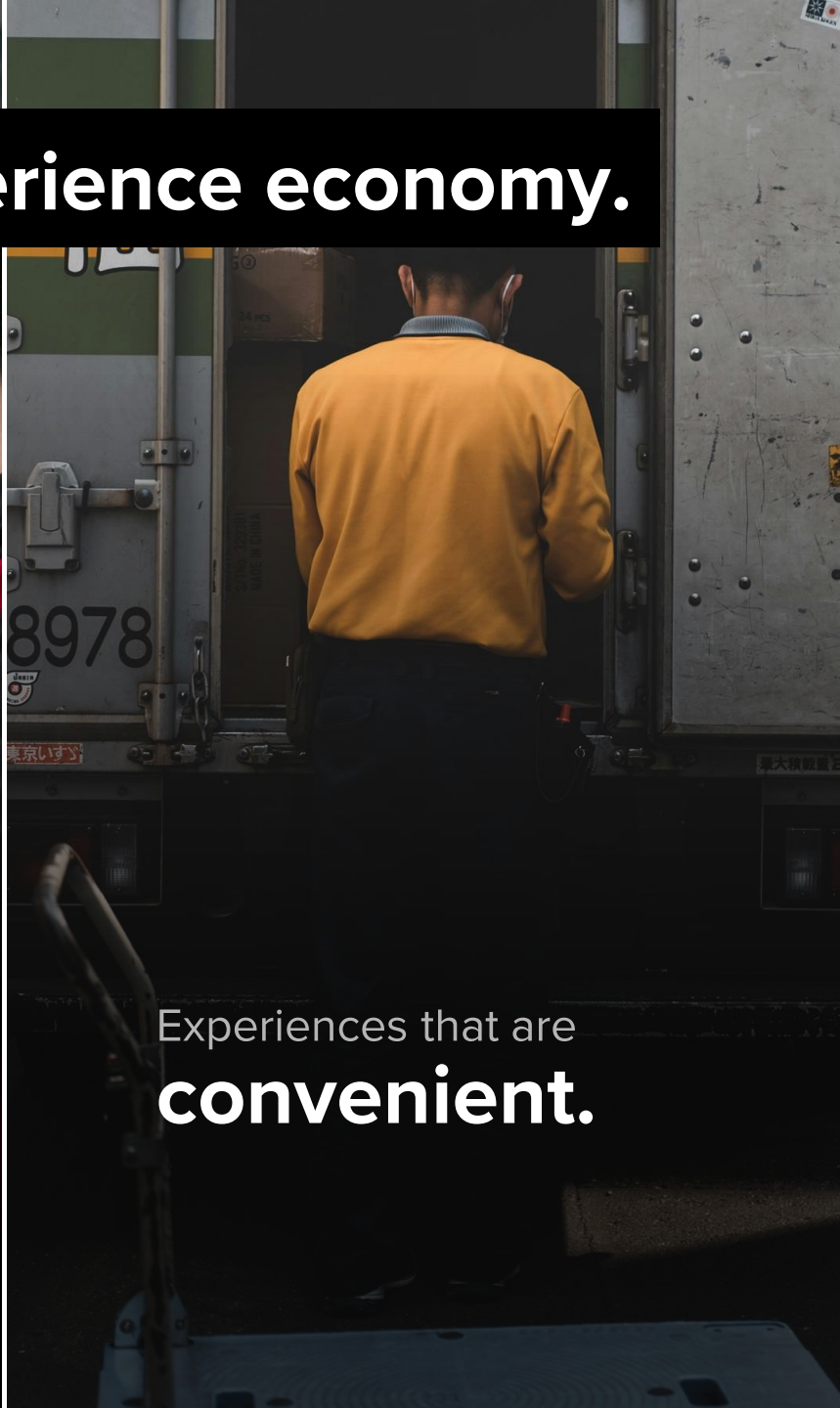
52%

of B2B buyers think it **takes far too long**
to make a purchase from their B2B suppliers

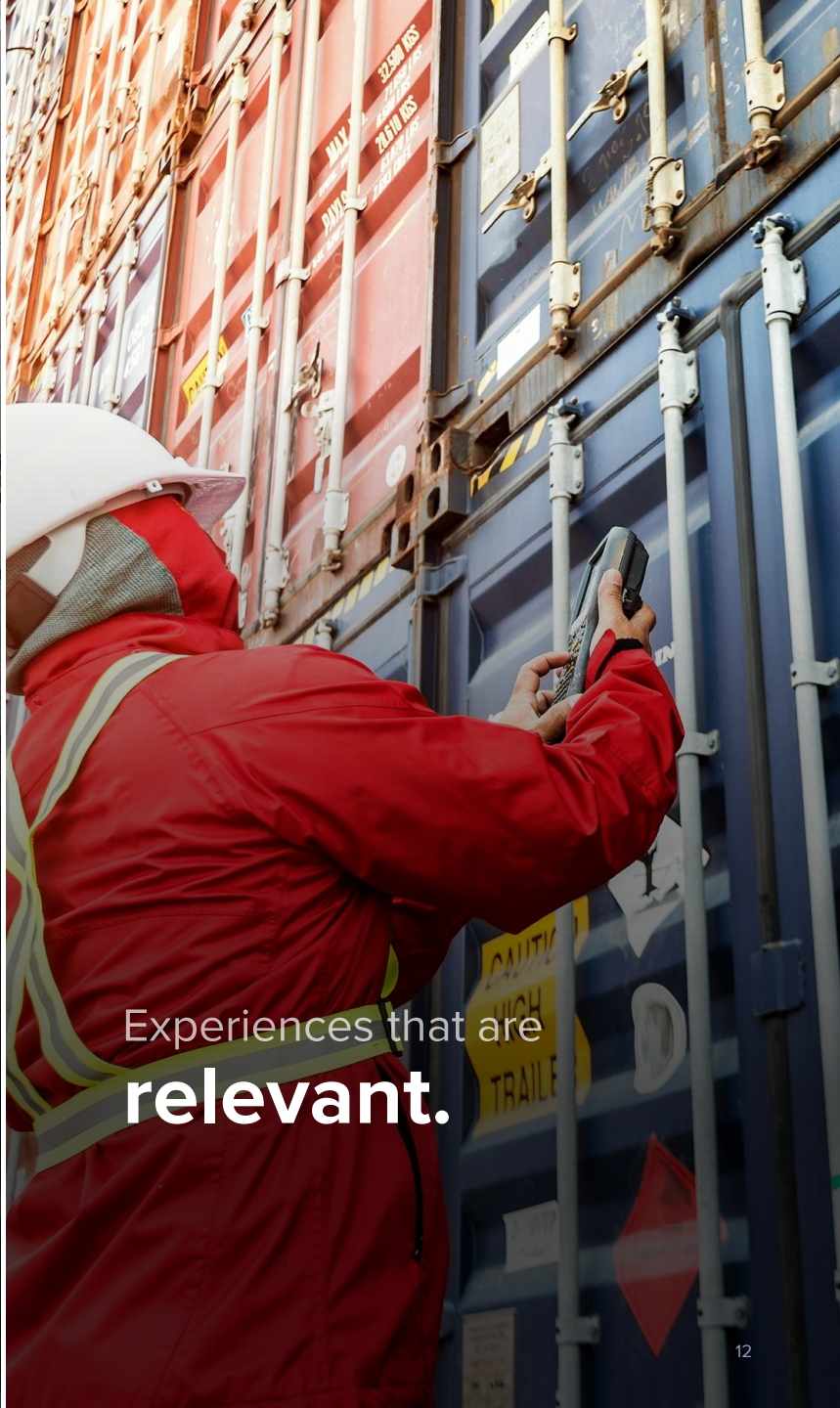


We power the experience economy.

Experiences that create
trust.



Experiences that are
convenient.



Experiences that are
relevant.

It's not how many times
you get it right.

It's how **few times**
you get it wrong.

Maximizing value across the entire B2B lifecycle requires a different approach.

“Do I feel safe signing a contract with them?”

“Are they active thought leaders?”

“Do they support us with expertise?”

“Do they offer enough variety and choice?”

“Are they there when I need them?”

“Do they offer tools to maximize value?”

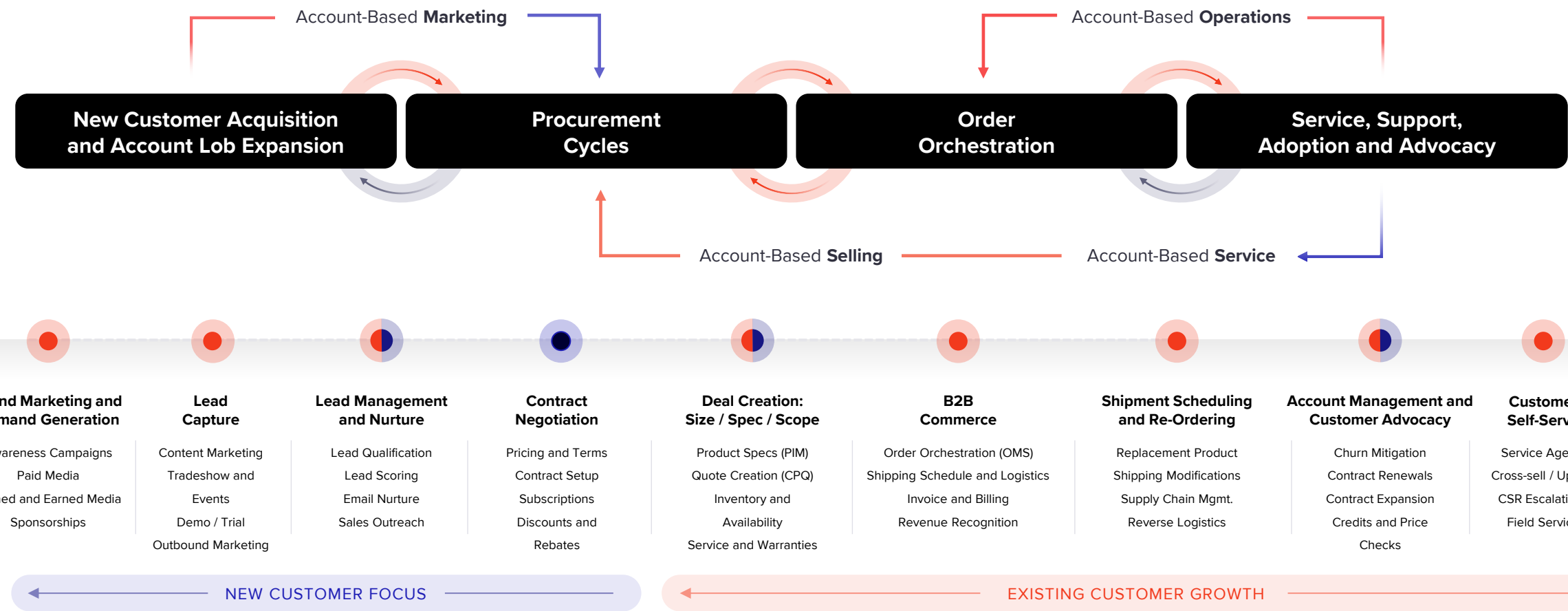
“Do they allow self-service customization?”

Account-based
everything.

Transforming your B2B Customer Experience.

The need to deliver dynamic **Account-Based Experiences** is being fueled by the **Modernization of Technologies** and the prolific **Rise of Artificial Intelligence**, creating a pivot point for many B2B industries.

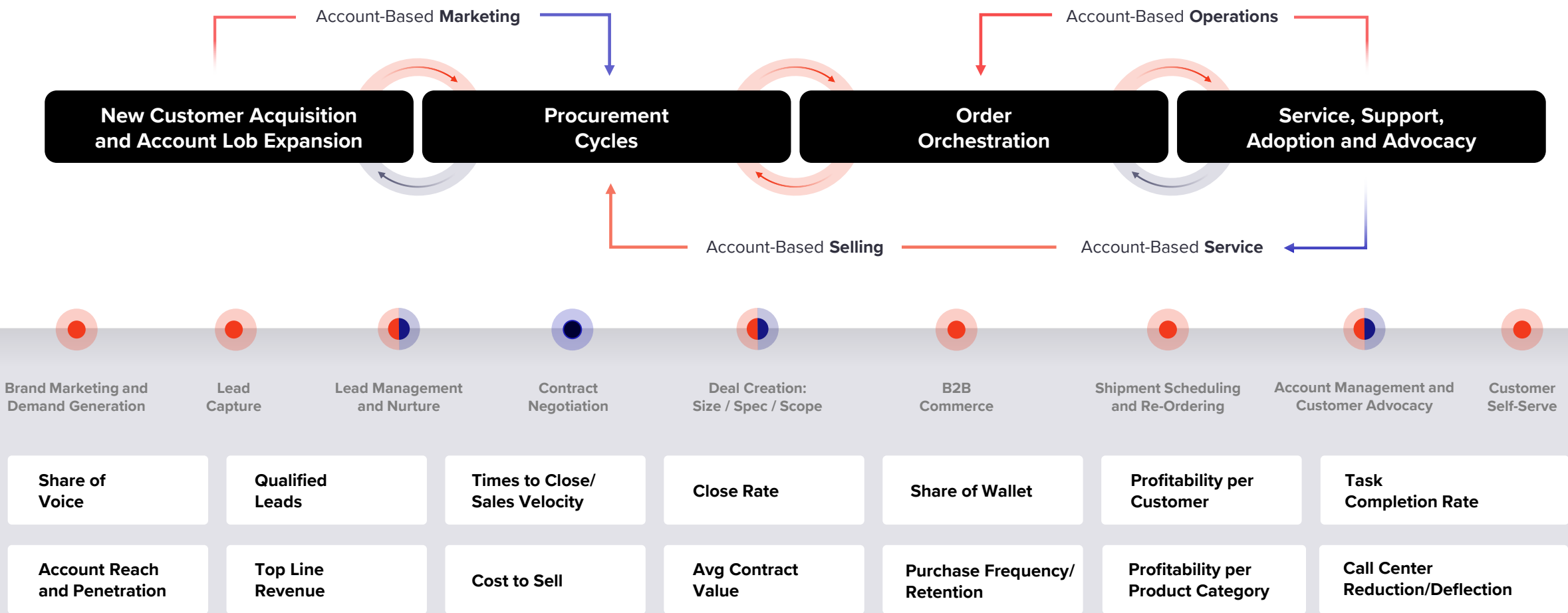
- Digital / AI Led
- Physical / Human Led



Driving Measurable Outcomes.

By leveraging **Account-Based Intelligence** to deliver leading **Account-Based Experiences**, B2B companies can more effectively drive **measurable outcomes** across these KPIs.

- Digital / AI Led
- Physical / Human Led



The impact of an “account-based everything” approach

■ Growth
■ Cost Out

Share of Voice

Receive **much higher NPS scores** (+83 vs +23)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Qualified Leads

25% increase in conversion of MQL to SQL
- Gartner

Times to Close/ Sales Velocity

Average sales cycles being **27% shorter**
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Close Rate

38% higher sales win rate
- Salesforce

Share of Wallet

Almost **twice as likely to be adopted for further products and services** (41% vs 23%)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Profitability per Customer

20%+ higher ROI for “account-based” investments
- Forrester

Task Completion Rate

28% increase in engagement rates
- Gartner

Account Reach and Penetration

28% faster revenue growth
- Salesforce

Top Line Revenue

14% increase in pipeline conversion rate
- Gartner

Cost to Sell

20%+ higher ROI for “account-based” investments
- Forrester

Avg Contract Value

13% increase in average deal size
- Gartner

Purchase Frequency/ Retention

Nearly 3 times as likely to see increased spend from their customers in the future (33% vs. 13% for other brands)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

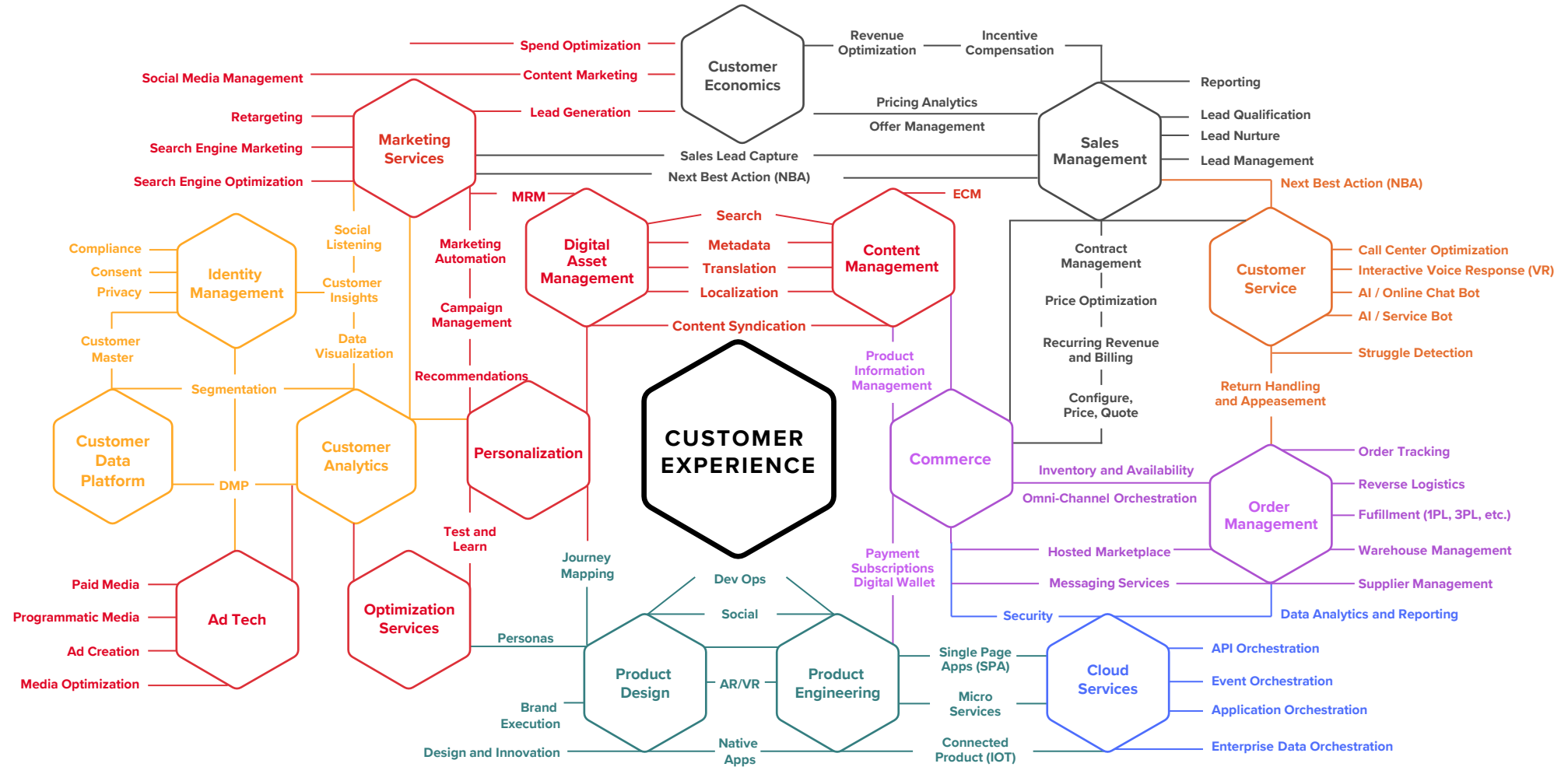
Profitability per Product Category

2.5x Brands expecting significantly higher profits in 5 years are 2.5x more likely to pursue ABM than those expecting a decline.

Call Center Reduction/ Deflection

Receive **much higher NPS scores** (+83 vs +23)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Visual model of the connected digital ecosystem



ACCOUNT-BASED

Everything

Champions: CEO, Board of Directors, C-Suite

ACCOUNT-BASED

Marketing

Audience: CMO, CDO, Product Marketing, Marketing Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Selling

Audience: CRO, CDO, CIO, CFO, Sales Operations, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Service & Advocacy

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Operations & Automation

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Everything

Champions: CEO, Board of Directors, C-Suite

ACCOUNT-BASED

Marketing

Audience: CMO, CDO, Product Marketing, Marketing Operations

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Audience: CRO, CDO, CIO, CFO, Sales Operations, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Service and Advocacy

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Operations and Automation

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Marketing

A highly personalized **go-to-market strategy** that's powered by **sales and marketing collaboration** to drive shared **business outcomes**.

It engages **key decision-makers** and influencers in **high-value accounts** through **data-driven, relevant touchpoints**.



ABM is no longer optional

...but it requires a fundamental **shift in strategy, execution, and measurement** to drive impactful **business outcomes**.

TRADITIONAL B2B MARKETING



ACCOUNT-BASED MARKETING

STRATEGY

- Siloed marketing and sales planning
- Firmographic targeting of broad audiences



- **Collaborative GTM approach**
- **Prioritizing accounts with intent to buy**

EXECUTION

- Generic value propositions and content
- Channel-centric campaigns backed by limited tech



- **Tailored content by stakeholder need**
- **Integrated tech to orchestrate account-based journeys**

MEASUREMENT

- Lead quantity and cost per lead



- **Account engagement, lifetime value, and deal acceleration**



B2B buyer behaviors speak for themselves

Marketing must earn buyer trust and address their specific needs through personalized, account-based strategies that shape vendor preference and accelerate pipeline growth.

69%

of buyers won't engage with sellers until they're approximately two-thirds of the way through their entire buying journey.¹

And by the time they reach out, 81% have a preferred vendor in mind.

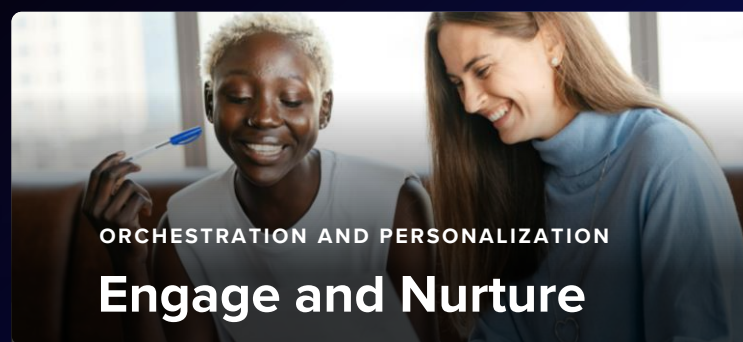
78%

of B2B buyers expect companies to adapt to their changing needs/preferences.²

ABM powers a connected buyer's journey



- Unify firmographic, technographic, and intent data to build target account lists and ICPs
- Use predictive scoring to prioritize high-propensity accounts and surface buying signals
- Enrich account records with buying group identification



- Map and track multi-threaded relationships across decision-makers and influencers
- Orchestrate coordinated outreach with dynamic content based on role, stage, and account context
- Leverage marketing automation integration for lifecycle triggers and account-based nurture streams



- Convert engaged buying groups through sales-driven relationship building and personalized outreach
- Track account health scores and engagement velocity to optimize pipeline progression
- Identify expansion opportunities through whitespace analysis and cross-sell/upsell triggers

We deliver relevant experiences to every buyer, at every stage

Through insights and signals that suggest where they are on their journey

Illustrative for Tech buyers

DATA

AUDIENCE INSIGHTS

Technographics
Firmographics
Organizational Structure
Budget Cycles/FY Timing
Historical Purchase Patterns
Role-specific Pain Points
Industry
Lifecycle Stage

CONTEXT

Market Conditions
Leadership Changes
Economic Indicators
Competitive Landscape Shifts

SIGNALS

Email/Digital Engagement
Website Engagement
Content Downloads
Event Participation
Search Behavior /
Keyword Research
Job Postings
Intent Signals

MARKETING FOCUS AND GOALS

DISCOVER



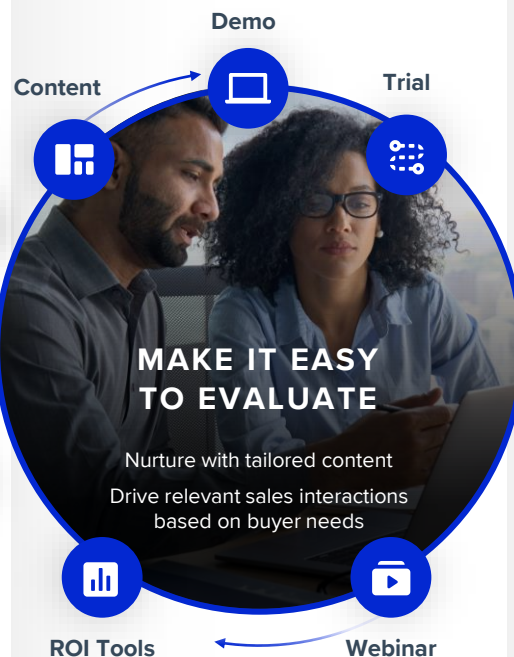
**BUILD
AWARENESS
ACROSS
BUYING
GROUP**



Reach and Frequency

Get on Consideration List

EVALUATE



Engagement + Acquisition

Nurture and Build Relationship

CONVERT

**MAKE IT
EASY TO BUY**

Sales



Online / App

Conversion

Validate Need for Purchase

IMPLEMENT/ONBOARD



Loyalty and Usage Frequency

Prove ROI

ADOPT/ADVOCATE

Case Studies
References
Reviews

**Encourage
Adoption
and
Advocacy**

Community Engagement
Social Proof
Testimonials

Advocacy / Contribution

Support and Grow Account

ACCOUNT BASED MARKETING OFFERINGS

Strategy and Enablement

- ABM Blueprint
- ABM Audit and Strategic Visioning
- Data and Platform Architecture and Roadmap



Insights and Planning

- ABM Pilot Program



Activation and Optimization

- ABM Activation and Program Management



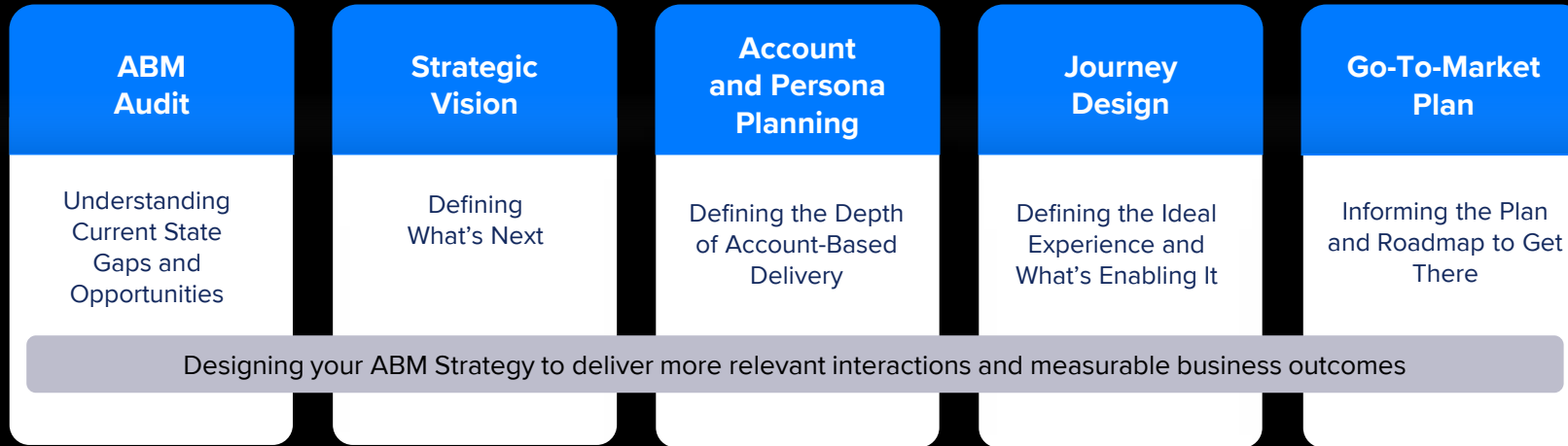
Where to Start?

The ABM Blueprint

Using our collaborative approach, Blueprints deliver a comprehensive strategy and execution plan, complete with a roadmap and business case – guided by an innovative, differentiated strategic vision.

STRATEGY

A BLUEPRINT FOR YOUR ABM



EXECUTION

BRINGING ABM TO MARKET



PART 2:

Case Studies and Why Merkle

This content provides reasons to believe that we are uniquely qualified to solve the client challenge presented in the preceding narrative.

Case studies should only be presented under NDA. If no NDA exists, the case studies should be blinded.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

Merkle is
your partner
to deliver

✓ **ABX Transformation
at Speed**

✓ **Customized E2E
ABX Solutions**

✓ **Relevance and Revenue**

Account-Based
experiences
are **proven**
to increase



ENGAGEMENT



REPUTATION



WIN RATE



DEAL SIZE



TAKING ABM GLOBAL AFTER SUCCESSFUL PILOT

Intel piloted an ABM program to their top 200 AMER accounts with expansion planned for 15 countries after these results:

152%

Contact
Acquisition for
Top Accounts

1.5x

Engagement
Rates QoQ

+15%

Marketing
Influenced
Revenue



HYPER-PERSONALIZED ACCOUNT TARGETING

To reach decision makers at 80 Fortune 500 companies mid-RFP, DXC broke through with a hyper-personalized campaign across every touchpoint and saw:

5100X

Increase in ROI



INTELLIGENT DATA-DRIVEN 1:1 EXPERIENCES

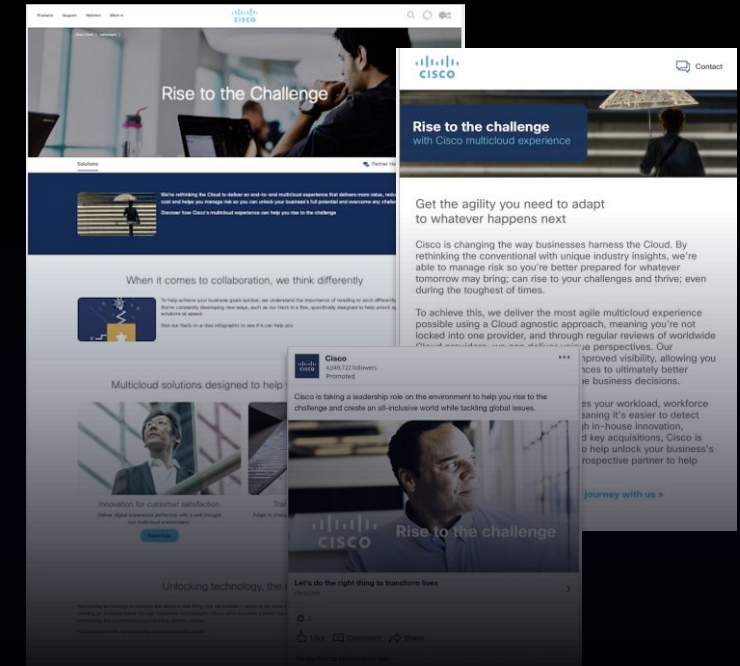
Cisco wasn't invited to their upcoming Cloud RFT for a current customer. Through a bespoke multi-channel strategy, Cisco successfully shifted perception from vendor to strategic partner.

1000%

Increase in new
site visits

145%

Increase in
return visits





Roadmap to Revenue: Turning ABX Platform Investment into Account-Based Growth

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

A B2B client needed strategic guidance to maximize their Demandbase ABX platform investment and accelerate cross-functional adoption. Without a prioritized use case roadmap aligned to marketing and sales objectives, they were unable to realize the platform's full revenue potential.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle conducted stakeholder interviews and collaborative workshops across marketing, sales, and operations to assess platform adoption and pinpoint implementation gaps. This discovery informed a comprehensive ABX Framework and Gap Assessment that identified 5 bespoke planning pillars and prioritized 35 use cases based on business impact and implementation effort. The phased adoption strategy aligned marketing and sales goals with measurable success metrics to drive platform implementation forward.



intel

Global. Integrated. Fueled By ABM.

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Intel needed to increase market share and pipeline in the fiercely competitive AI market. They knew ABX was the path to ROI success. The job was to quickly assess areas for ABX optimization, identify a plan to fill gaps, build and implement an integrated global operating model, pilot and expand.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle started with an ABX maturity assessment and rapidly followed with recommendations and a pilot implementation to 200 top America's accounts. We also developed a global integrated campaign planning model, laying out processes and ways of working for omni-channel campaign planning, including ABM. The pilot has been a great success, driving topline KPIs beyond their existing campaigns. We're currently in the process of rolling out to 15 countries across the globe.

152%

Contact
Acquisition for
Top Accounts

1.5x

Engagement
Rates QoQ

+15%

Marketing
Influenced
Revenue in the
first 2 months
post-launch



Proven AI via
1,000s of
deployments.

If you're not
thinking Intel,

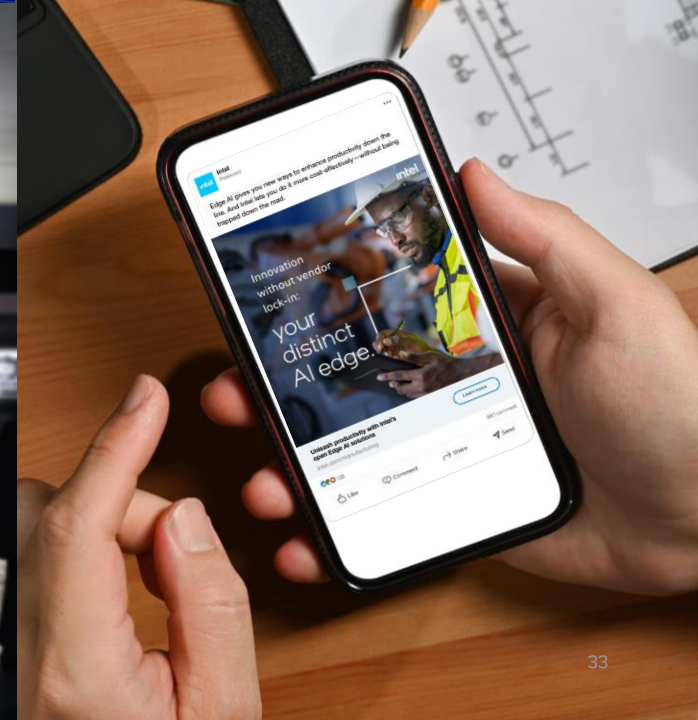
THINK AGAIN



With a lower TCO,
more AI programs
are a go.

If you're not
thinking Intel,

think again





1:1 ABM Messaging Drives Auto Wins for Intel

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

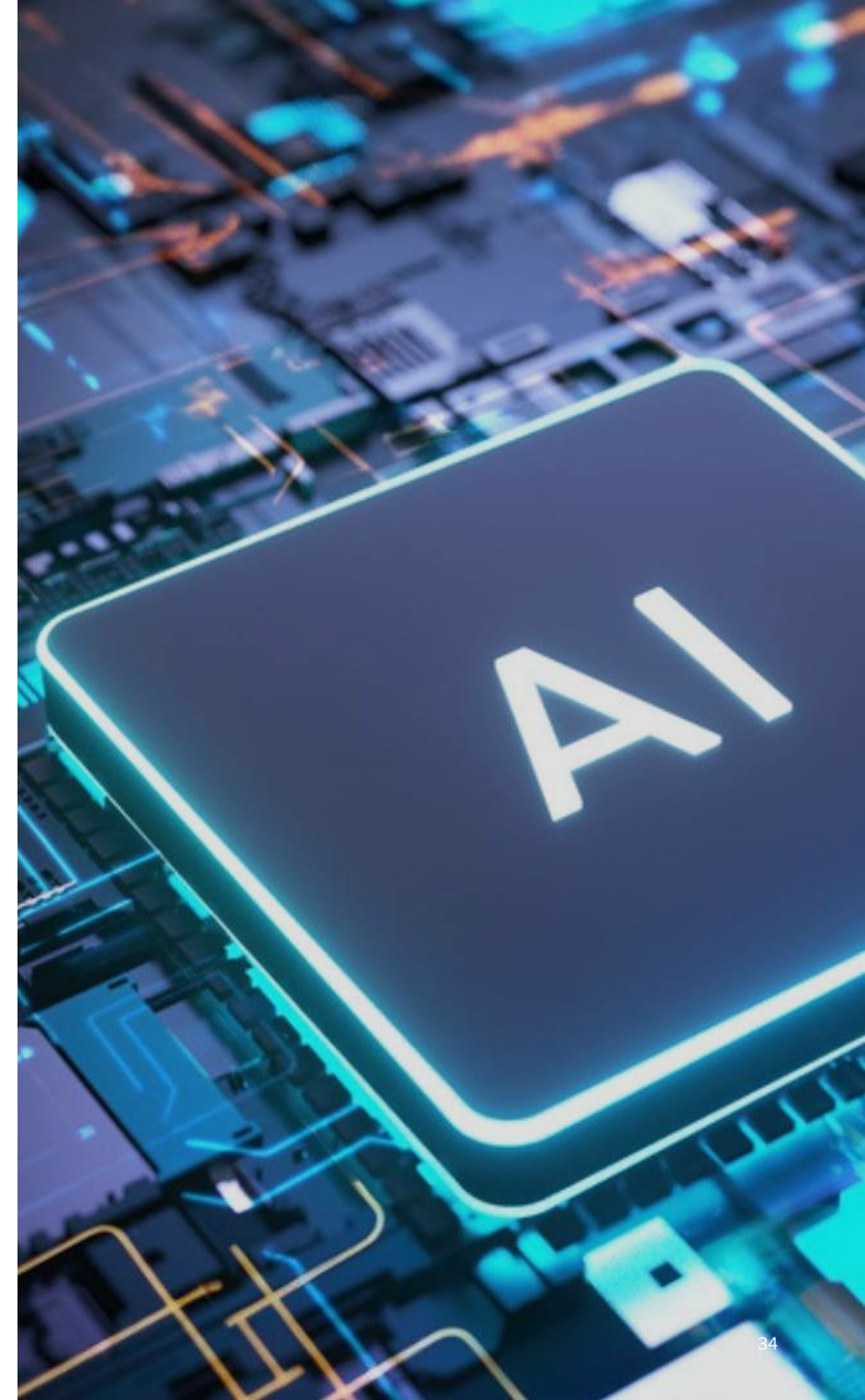
Intel needed to drive 1:1 ABM for a Top 10 Automotive Client but faced perception as an innovation laggard and lacked target contact knowledge.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle developed a full-funnel phased approach prioritizing quick-wins to deliver immediate value. We provided GTM and tactical support to build awareness and generate leads. By shifting Intel's brand perception from innovation laggard to automotive technology leader, we were able to expand their marketing contact list substantially across their targeted account. By establishing this strategic approach, Intel was able to build long-term relationships and drive measurable business outcomes in reputation and revenue across their ABM programs.

935

Expanded 1P Data by 935
qualified opt-ins for
engagement and nurturing



Building the foundation for account-centric growth

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

CHEP's B2B marketing lacked strategic direction due to fragmented measurement systems that prevented clear ROI demonstration. They needed a strategic foundation to drive account-centric growth with marketing communications that effectively reach complex buying groups.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle established a unified measurement framework with KPIs aligned to business objectives, shifting CHEP from campaign optimization to revenue growth. We developed a strategic messaging framework with personalized communications for 3 distinct buying personas, then delivered a global experience blueprint for scalable buyer journey orchestration across 5 countries and 2 verticals.





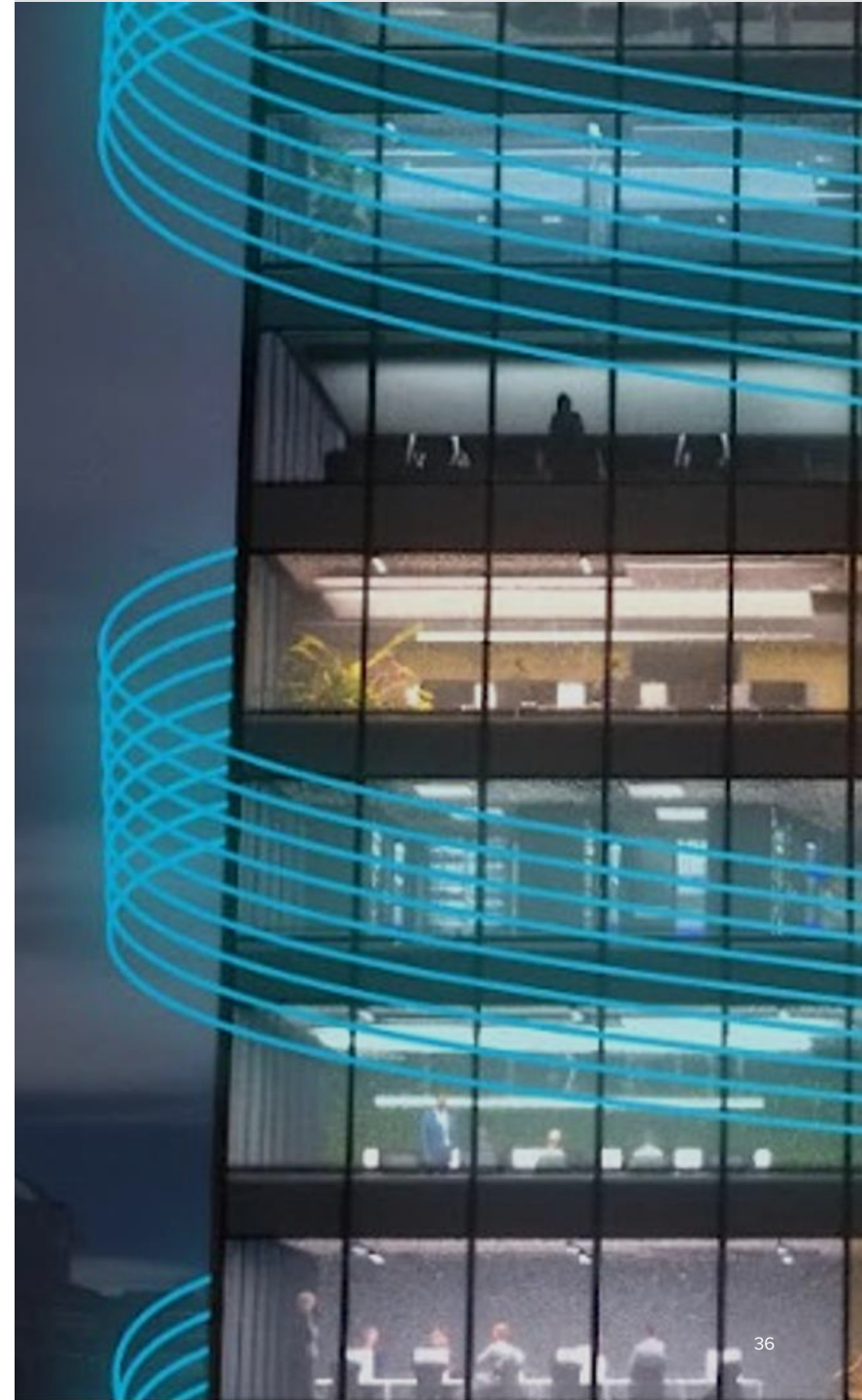
Integrated Experience Plans From Data-Fueled Insights

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

In a rapidly evolving and competitive B2B landscape, Cisco faced the challenge of developing a global, integrated campaign strategy that delivered a cohesive customer experience across a multitude of channels. Customer experiences and messaging needed to be relevant to ABM personas within each region to drive stronger 1:1 relationships and sustainable business growth.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle infused data-driven insights to design highly relevant B2B buyer journeys, creating 13 channel categories within one integrated campaign plan spanning Paid Media, Paid Search, OOH, Content Syndication, Website, Influencers, Events, Communities, Owned Social, and Email. We developed 9 audience-specific experience plans with custom, relevant messaging and account-based variations across 3 personas and 3 regions, enabling stronger engagement and loyalty in the evolving B2B landscape.





Hyper-Personalized Account Targeting

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

DXC needed to reach key decision makers at Digital 80 companies (top Fortune 500) investing in digital transformation who were mid-RFP.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle deployed a hyper-targeted ABM approach, mapping target audience commute patterns to deliver personalized digital out of home (DOOH) advertising reinforced with geo-targeted mobile displays at office locations, personalized email and direct mail, account-specific landing pages, and nurture campaigns. Creative was personalized to the account and persona level—including the target company name in the messaging.

5100X

Increase in ROI by 5100X





Creating Intelligent Data-driven 1:1 Experiences

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

A key account was 6 months from issuing a Cloud RFT, but Cisco wasn't invited to tender despite being their primary networking provider. They needed to understand customer needs and strategic priorities to reposition Cisco as a credible Cloud partner.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Through deep discovery and strategic planning, Merkle produced a bespoke messaging framework, CRM and media strategy with creative assets including training modules, events and multi-channel content. This approach successfully changed Cisco's perception from networking provider to multi-cloud partner, earning them an invitation to pitch.

1,000%

Over 1,000% new site visitors driven by personalized messaging

145%

Return site visits increased by 145%



PART 3:

Wedges and Engagements

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering. The wedges, or door openers, are priced to help get the first sale. The engagements fit various needs related to the offering. Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

ABM Audit and Strategic Visioning

We deliver actionable insights on your current ABM capabilities, critical gaps, and organizational readiness to inform how you build a unified roadmap, prioritize resources, and accelerate impact with confidence.



Our Approach

Turn cross-functional discovery into strategic alignment with a clear roadmap that prioritizes what matters most for your ABM transformation.

Your Challenges

- Nascent or fragmented ABM efforts not delivering expected revenue impact
- Lack of clarity on how to operationalize and scale ABM across the organization
- Resources dispersed across too many initiatives without unified direction
- Misalignment between marketing, sales, and leadership on vision and priorities

Our Solution

- Stakeholder discovery across sales, marketing, operations, and technology
- Capability assessment across account strategy, technology, data, content, and media
- Industry benchmarking to identify critical gaps and organizational readiness
- Strategic visioning workshop to align leadership on North Star vision and roadmap

What You Get

- ABM audit and shared vision across marketing, sales, and leadership
- Clear understanding of what's working today vs. where resources are needed
- Prioritized roadmap that accelerates impact and reduces wasted effort
- Foundation to operationalize and scale ABM with confidence

Representative
Clients:

intel.

||| ||| ||| |||
CISCO

VISA

Data and Tech Architecture and Roadmap

We design the data infrastructure and technology architecture you need to enable account-based targeting, coordinated orchestration, and measurable account engagement at scale to prove ROI.

Our Approach

Build an effective data and technology foundation.

Your Challenges

- Martech stack built for lead-based marketing that can't support account-level orchestration
- Marketing automation, ABM platforms, and intent tools operating in silos
- Data quality issues, manual workflows, and disconnected systems that prevent precision targeting and measurable impact

Our Solution

- Current state assessment of martech capabilities, data quality, and integration maturity
- Data architecture design including account matching logic, buying group identification, and governance protocols
- Platform strategy and integration blueprint with tech recommendations and data requirements
- Phased implementation roadmap with dependencies, sequencing, and realistic timelines

What You Get

- Single source of truth for account data across your sales and marketing systems
- Orchestrate at scale with precision targeting across all your channels
- Technical infrastructure that can track ABM influence on pipeline, revenue, and ROI

Representative
Clients:

LUMEN®

CISCO

VISA

Pilot Program

We deliver a documented pilot playbook including account selection, contact strategy, success metrics, and testing methodology that builds organizational confidence through tangible results—improved account engagement, pipeline acceleration, and enhanced sales-marketing alignment.



Our Approach

Prove ABM's value with a targeted pilot that delivers quick wins and establishes the foundation for scaled adoption across your organization.

Your Challenges

- Lacking ABM buy-in and enterprise-wide adoption without proof of concept
- Limited budgets, competing priorities, and executive skepticism
- No understanding account-level impact to rationalize future investments/scalability

Our Solution

- Design pilot program framework including account selection criteria, contact strategy, success metrics, and testing methodology
- Provide 1:1 or 1:few pilot campaign strategy for personalized account experiences
- Establish a measurement framework to track account engagement, pipeline impact, velocity improvements, and program efficiency

What You Get

- Documented pilot playbook with account selection, contact strategy, and test plan
- Success metrics that inform baseline performance for your pilot accounts and validate need for broader, scaled program
- Proven correlation between account-level activities and revenue outcomes

Representative
Clients:

intel

SAMSUNG

ABM Blueprint

We deliver organizational alignment around a cohesive strategy with a detailed go-to-market activation plan and phased roadmap that connects your ABM strategy to execution and measurable business outcomes—with defined success metrics that create accountability and enable continuous optimization.

Our Approach

Transform fragmented ABM efforts into a unified strategy with clear priorities, orchestrated journeys, and an actionable roadmap to drive revenue impact.

Your Challenges

- Fragmented, inconsistent ABM efforts not delivering expected revenue impact
- Sales and marketing misaligned on strategy and how to operationalize ABM at scale
- Resources dispersed across too many initiatives without unified direction

Our Solution

- ABM audit to assess capabilities and benchmark against industry standards
- Strategic vision workshop to align leadership on North Star vision and success metrics
- Account and persona planning with prioritization and decision-making moment mapping
- Journey design with messaging, touchpoints, and experiences based on audience needs
- Go-to-market plan with detailed, actionable roadmap for your prioritized initiatives

What You Get

- Organizational alignment across marketing, sales, and leadership
- Clear line of sight from ABM activities to business outcomes
- Plan to orchestrate journeys with defined touchpoints, messaging, and channel activation
- Actionable implementation roadmap



Activation and Program Management

We deliver coordinated campaign execution with governance protocols, performance optimization frameworks, and continuous testing that builds institutional knowledge—enabling your teams to understand what's working and scale successful tactics across accounts and segments.

Our Approach

Execute and manage scalable ABM programs and campaigns.

Your Challenges

- Execution quality varies without dedicated program management and governance
- Limited Internal resources and capabilities to properly orchestrate across channels
- Missing systematic testing, learning frameworks, and continuous optimization

Our Solution

- Campaign strategy, planning, and orchestration
- Content and creative development to support tiered account strategies
- Program management and governance while monitoring results and informing optimizations

What You Get

- Consistent campaign execution across all touchpoints that increases account engagement and velocity
- Sales adoption and productivity gains through actionable insights and collaborative planning
- Measurable revenue impact with visibility into performance, pipeline contribution, and marketing-influenced opportunities
- Compounding performance gains through systematic testing, learning capture, and optimization

Representative
Clients:

SAMSUNG

Protective 

PART 4: Training

The aim of this **INTERNAL ONLY** section is for sales teams to learn the details of the offering, how it fits in the overall Merkle capability landscape, the various packages you can sell within this offering based on client needs, and how to sell it to clients and prospects.

Market Contacts

CAT
JOLLY



ABM Lead
B2B Strategy Lead

LISA
KATZ



CRM Strategy Lead
SVP CXM

DAVID
NOVAK



Global Head of CRM
EVP CXM

STEVE
CONWAY



**B2B
Transformation
Solution Lead**
VP – B2B

MIKE
BRUNST



Executive Sales Lead
EVP CX&C

ERIC
BUSS



Executive Sponsor
EVP – CX&C

Key Champions of ABM



	CMO	Digital Marketer	Product Marketing Lead	MarTech Lead	Chief Revenue Officer
	“My job extends far beyond marketing – I identify market opportunities and collaborate across the organization to shape company-wide strategies.”	“I orchestrate targeted digital experiences that build meaningful connections with key accounts to move buyers through their journeys.”	“I need to ensure we remain competitive and stay ahead of market trends by continuously adapting to our customers’ evolving needs and expectations.”	“I architect the digital ecosystem where marketing vision and technical execution converge—connecting data to transform how we engage with our audience.”	“I’m not just responsible for driving sales, I lead sustainable revenue growth across the entire organization.”
MOTIVATIONS	Revenue Growth, ROI, Market Expansion	Driving Qualified Leads, Personalizing Experiences	Product/Message Relevancy Efficiency and ROI	Operational Efficiency Supporting Organizational Growth and Scalability	Increase Sales Velocity Driving Business Growth and Revenue
PAIN POINTS	Strategic Alignment Across GTM Teams Proving Impact	Reaching the Right Decision-Makers Within Key Accounts	Keeping up with Buyer Needs and Expectations	Legacy Systems and Budget Constraints Integrating Tech and Data Silos	Strategic Alignment Across GTM Teams Adapting to Market Shifts

Account-Based Marketing (ABM)



Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

CMO/Digital Marketer/Product Marketing Lead/Chief Revenue Officer

B2B marketing and revenue leaders face mounting pressure to demonstrate marketing's direct contribution to pipeline and revenue while navigating increasingly complex buying committees and longer sales cycles. They need to prove ROI on marketing investments while aligning fragmented efforts across marketing, sales, and customer success teams.

Concern #1

Demonstrating marketing ROI

Concern #2

Sales and Marketing Alignment

Concern #3

Scaling personalization

PRIMARY OUTCOMES

Outcome	Why it Matters
Improved Win Rates	80% say win rates are higher for ABM accounts – Average lift was 13% ²
Improved ROI	91% said ABM accounts had higher ROI than control – Average lift was over 10% ²
Higher Deal Sizes	73% said average deal size was higher for ABM accounts – Average lift was 21% ²
Increased Annual Contract Value (ACV)	2x higher annual contract value per year with ABM – Indexed ACV 211 vs. 100 ¹
Better Engagement	99% said account engagement was higher with ABM – Average lift was 20% ²
Increased Advocacy	92% Increase in NPS scores for ABM accounts – Average 73 vs. 38 NPS ¹



PART 1: LEARN THE OFFERING

Account-Based Marketing (ABM)



Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

TARGET INDUSTRIES

Describe specific industries or verticals where this offering is particularly relevant.

Industry	Why it Matters
Technology and Software	Complex buying committees (12+ stakeholders), long sales cycles (6-18 months), and high deal values make personalized account engagement essential for competitive differentiation
Financial Services	Highly regulated environment requires compliant, personalized engagement strategies. Account concentration and relationship-driven sales make ABM a natural fit for banking, insurance, and wealth management
Manufacturing and Industrial	Lengthy consideration cycles, technical buying committees, and relationship-based selling align perfectly with account-focused strategies, especially for capital equipment and enterprise solutions



PART 1: LEARN THE OFFERING

Account-Based Marketing
(ABM)

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on price point, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

Client-facing pricing slides for each engagement can be found on the following slides.

Key competitors	Traditional Agency Networks	Large holding company agencies (WPP, Publicis, IPG, Omnicom) offer creative and media services but often lack specialized ABM expertise, technology implementation capabilities, and data-driven precision targeting.
	Consulting Firms	Management consultancies (Accenture, Deloitte, PwC) provide strategic transformation but often lack activation capabilities through ABM platforms, creative execution, and ongoing program management.
	Martech Platforms	Salesforce Account Engagement, Adobe Marketo Engage, HubSpot offer ABM features within broader platforms but require significant implementation support and lack the strategic consulting to drive organizational change.
Key Alliances	Adobe, Salesforce, Demandbase, Bombora, LinkedIn	

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Account-Based Marketing (ABM)



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

OUR STORY: KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

Merkle uniquely combines data-driven intelligence, enterprise technology implementation, and creative execution to deliver measurable ABM transformations—not just strategy documents. Our approach connects three critical capabilities competitors can't match:

End-to-End Transformation Expertise: We don't stop at strategy. We architect the technology, implement the platforms, design the experiences, execute the campaigns, and manage ongoing optimization.

Data and Technology Foundation: We bring unmatched expertise in Customer Data Platforms, marketing automation, and MarTech integration—enabling the precision targeting and measurement infrastructure required for ABM at scale.

Measurable Business Impact: We establish clear KPIs upfront and tie every initiative to revenue outcomes—while focusing on pipeline velocity, improving win rates, and driving higher account engagement.

OUR WORK

Client	Project	Market	Description	Link to case
Intel	ABM	Americas	Increasing market share and pipeline with global, integrated ABM	LINK
Brambles	ABM Experience Planning	North America + Europe	Building the foundation for account-centric growth	LINK
Visa	ABM Platform Adoption Roadmap	Americas	Roadmap to revenue: turning ABX platform investment into account-based growth	LINK

MARKET VALIDATION

#Dentsu is 1 in B2B Industry Awards



Graphis



B2B Marketing
#1 US B2B Marketing Agency
#1 Global B2B Marketing Agency in 2025

The Drum.
B2B Awards



“Dentsu is unique in building end-to-end bespoke solutions for clients, marrying B2B expertise with identity, CX, media, social content production, and more.” - FORRESTER

“No other agency offers the same capability...it's B2B the way it should be.” - GARTNER

PART 1: LEARN THE OFFERING

Account-Based Marketing (ABM)



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

GUIDANCE AND GUIDELINES

When ABM is the right approach:

- Account's deal size or lifetime value warrants investment of ABM and personalization
- Sales cycles is complex and involves multiple stakeholders across departments
- Market concentration allows focus on finite account universe
- Sales and marketing alignment is a strategic priority

When to be cautious:

- Transactional, low-consideration purchases
- Undifferentiated commodity products where price is the primary driver
- Organizations without executive sponsorship or sales-marketing alignment
- Immature data infrastructure or significant data quality issues
- Prioritizes lead volume over account engagement

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

Client signals that indicate ABM readiness:

- Our best accounts aren't growing like they should be
- Marketing runs campaigns but sales doesn't have insight into how target accounts are engaging
- We're trying to personalize but it's manual and doesn't scale
- We're losing deals in late stages to competitors
- Marketing generates leads but sales says they're not qualified
- We need better visibility into account engagement across our target list
- Our marketing spend isn't translating to pipeline in our top accounts
- Our marketing budget is in question since we can't show clear ROI so we need to be better informed which activities are influencing revenue
- Our data lives in silos and no one has a complete view of account engagement

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

- What percentage of your revenue comes from your top [100] accounts? (Reveals account concentration)
- How many stakeholders are typically involved in buying decisions? (Indicates committee complexity)
- How would you characterize sales and marketing alignment today? (Exposes organizational readiness)
- What systems do you use for CRM, marketing automation, and intent data? (Identifies technical starting point)
- How do you currently measure marketing's contribution to pipeline and revenue? (Reveals measurement maturity)
- What's your average deal size and sales cycle length? (Validates ABM economic viability)

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

ACCOUNT-BASED MARKETING (ABM)

Audit and Strategic Visioning

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Account-Based Marketing efforts are nascent, fragmented, inconsistent, or not delivering expected revenue impact. They lack clarity on how to operationalize and scale ABM while aligning internal teams around a common vision and plan. As a result, resources are dispersed across too many initiatives without a unified direction, limiting ABM’s contribution to pipeline, deal velocity, and revenue.

OBJECTIVE

Gain stakeholder alignment on future ABM initiatives by assessing current capabilities and identifying critical gaps through cross-functional discovery and industry benchmarking. Align leadership on a compelling North Star vision that connects ABM investment to business objectives, enabling informed decisions about resource allocation and transformation approach.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Account and Persona Planning, Journey Design, Go-To-Market Plan, ABM Activation and Program Management

CLIENT

Intel

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- Execute stakeholder discovery interviews with sales, marketing, operations, and technology leaders to understand current ABM approach, challenges, and aspirations
- Assess ABM capabilities across key dimensions: account strategy and experience, technology and data ecosystem, content and creative, media activation, and performance measurement
- Benchmark current state against industry standards and best practices to identify critical gaps and organizational readiness
- Facilitate strategic visioning workshop to align on North Star vision
- Develop high-level strategic roadmap of prioritized recommendations to operationalize the future ABM strategy—focusing on impact, effort, and business alignment
- Establish goals and KPIs to track success

Investment: \$xx – xx,000

Timing: xx weeks

Outcomes:

- ABM audit and shared vision across marketing, sales, and leadership
- Clear understanding of what is working today vs. where investment and resources are needed
- Prioritized roadmap that accelerates impact and reduces wasted effort
- Defined goals, success metrics, and performance indicators for ABM programs
- Foundation to operationalize and scale ABM with confidence

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

ACCOUNT-BASED MARKETING (ABM)

Data and Tech Architecture and Roadmap

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Martech stacks are often built for lead-based marketing and can't support account-level orchestration. CRMs, marketing automation, ABM platforms, and intent tools often operate in silos, preventing coordinated engagement and creating fragmented account views across sales and marketing.

Data quality issues, manual workflows, and disconnected systems make it difficult to identify buying groups, execute precision targeting, or prove ABM's impact on pipeline. ABM strategy will fail in execution without integrated data infrastructure and the right platform architecture.

OBJECTIVE

Design the data infrastructure and technology architecture required to enable cross-functional account-based targeting, coordinated orchestration, and measurable account engagement at scale—with a phased implementation roadmap that balances quick wins with long-term transformation.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Journey Design, Go-To-Market Plan, ABM Activation and Program Management

CLIENT

Lumen, Visa

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- Current State Assessment: Audit existing martech capabilities, data quality, integration maturity, and gaps between experience strategy requirements and current technical capabilities
- Data Architecture Design: Identity resolution strategy, account matching logic, buying group identification framework, data flows/integration map, and governance protocols
- Platform Strategy and Integration Blueprint: Technology recommendations, integration architecture, activation capability mapping, and measurement/attribution instrumentation design
- Phased Implementation Roadmap: Phased plan with dependencies, sequencing, resource requirements, and realistic timelines
- Technical Documentation: Integration requirements, data dictionary and field mapping, attribution model definitions, and platform configuration guides for IT and marketing operations teams

Investment: \$xx – xx,000

Timing: xx weeks

Outcomes:

- Establish a single source of truth for account data across sales and marketing systems, enabling accurate targeting and buying group identification
- Orchestration at scale with precision targeting and connected touchpoints across paid, owned, and earned channels based on real-time account engagement and intent signals
- Enabling measurable business impact that connects ABM tactics to pipeline influence, revenue impact, ROI, improved deal velocity, and/or win rates

PART 1: LEARN THE OFFERING

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

ACCOUNT-BASED MARKETING (ABM)

Pilot Program

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Organizations can't secure ABM buy-in and enterprise-wide adoption without proof of concept demonstrating measurable impact to justify initial investment. Limited budgets, competing priorities, and executive skepticism create barriers to adoption—especially when teams can't demonstrate account-level impact before committing to technology, data, and operational requirements to support it at scale.

OBJECTIVE

Inform a focused ABM pilot targeting high-value accounts to demonstrate measurable business impact and validate the need to scale ABM. Build organizational confidence through tangible results including improved account engagement, pipeline acceleration, and enhanced sales-marketing alignment.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Data and Tech Architecture and Roadmap, Op Model and Change Management, Training and Capability Development, ABM Activation and Program Management, Creative and Content Development, B2B Platform Implementation and Integration

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- Light discovery and review of existing marketing approach to inform pilot
- Design pilot program framework including account selection criteria, contact strategy, success metrics, and testing methodology aligned to business objectives
- Provide 1:1 or 1:Few pilot campaign strategy for personalized account experiences across paid, owned, and sales channels utilizing existing technology capabilities
- Establish a measurement framework to track account engagement, pipeline impact, velocity improvements, and program efficiency metrics

Investment: \$xx – xx,000

Timing: 8 weeks

Assumptions: Client owns creative execution, campaign activation, and ongoing campaign management and measurement—Merkle can support at an additional cost

Outcomes:

- Documented pilot playbook including account selection, contact strategy, success metrics, and test plan
- Success metric benchmarks that inform baseline performance for pilot accounts and validate need for a broader, scaled program
- Proven correlation between account-level activities and revenue outcomes

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

ACCOUNT-BASED MARKETING (ABM)

ABM Blueprint

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

ABM efforts are fragmented, inconsistent, and not delivering expected revenue impact. Organizations struggle to align sales and marketing around a cohesive strategy and lack clarity on how to operationalize and scale ABM effectively. Resources are often dispersed across too many initiatives without a unified direction—limiting ABM's contribution to pipeline, deal velocity, and revenue.

Many companies lack the foundational elements needed for success: defined North Star vision, prioritized account lists with proper segmentation, persona intelligence mapped to decision-making moments, and integrated activation plans that connect paid, owned, and earned channels.

OBJECTIVE

Develop a comprehensive ABM strategic foundation that establishes the vision, identifies priority accounts and personas, designs targeted buyer journeys, and creates a detailed go-to-market activation plan—with a phased roadmap that connects strategy to execution and measurable business outcomes.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

ABM Activation and Program Management, Operating Model and Change Management, Training and Capability Development, Creative and Content Development, B2B Platform Implementation and Integration

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- ABM Audit: Assess existing ABM capabilities and benchmark against industry standards to identify gaps and opportunities
- Strategic Vision: Align on the North Star Vision to guide ABM priorities and what's defining success
- Account and Persona Planning: Define account prioritization and personas that define level of customization needed for contact strategy
- Journey Design: Plan messaging, touchpoints, and experiences based on audience needs—while identifying data and tech requirements to enable journey orchestration
- Go-To-Market Plan: Provide a detailed, actionable plan with prioritized initiatives

Investment: \$xx – xx,000

Timing: 8-10 weeks

Assumptions: Client owns creative execution, campaign activation, and ongoing campaign management and measurement—Merkle can support at an additional cost

Outcomes:

- Organizational alignment that accelerates decision-making and reduces friction between marketing, sales, and leadership on account priorities and resource allocation
- Clear line of sight from ABM activities to business outcomes, with defined success metrics that create accountability and enable continuous optimization
- Ability to orchestrate journeys based on defined touchpoints, messaging architecture, and channel activation plans across paid, owned, and earned media
- Confidence to execute with speed, based on an actionable implementation roadmap that considers resource constraints

PART 1: LEARN THE OFFERING

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

ACCOUNT-BASED MARKETING (ABM)

Activation and Program Management

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Organizations have ABM strategies but struggle to execute consistently at scale. Without dedicated program management and governance, execution quality varies across accounts and segments, leading to missed opportunities and underwhelming results.

Programs lack systematic testing, learning frameworks, and continuous optimization—preventing teams from understanding what's working and scaling successful tactics.

OBJECTIVE

Orchestrate ABM campaigns across paid, owned, and earned channels—while establishing program management infrastructure, governance protocols, and performance optimization frameworks that drive consistent execution, sales adoption, and measurable revenue impact.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Operating Model and Change Management, Training and Capability Development, Creative and Content Development, B2B Platform Implementation and Integration

CLIENT

Intel

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- Campaign Strategy and Planning: Multi-touch campaign architecture, content and messaging framework mapped to buying stages, channel orchestration strategy, and sequenced campaign calendar
- Content and Creative Development: Account-tiered content strategy (1:1, 1:Few, 1:Many), messaging playbooks and sales enablement assets, personalization frameworks
- Campaign Execution and Orchestration: Campaign deployment across platforms, audience targeting configuration, trigger-based automation setup, and cross-channel coordination
- Program Management and Governance: RACI and accountability frameworks, spring planning and tracking, and issue resolution
- Performance Monitoring and Optimization: Real-time dashboards and reporting, test and learn plan, continuous optimization, and quarterly business reviews

Investment: \$xx – xx,000

Timing: Ongoing Retainer

Outcomes:

- Consistent, high-quality campaign execution that delivers coordinated experiences across all touchpoints, increasing account engagement and velocity through the buying journey
- Sales adoption and productivity gains through actionable account insights, relevant enablement assets, and collaborative planning
- Measurable revenue impact with clear visibility into campaign performance, pipeline contribution, and marketing-influenced opportunities to demonstrate ROI
- Compounding performance gains over time as systematic testing, learning capture, and optimization build repeatable processes and institutional knowledge

